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## Reflection and Preparation

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### How to prepare for your Professional Growth Meeting

You should attend your professional growth conversation having reflected on the goals you would like to set and your progress.

Your upcoming professional growth conversation is a valuable opportunity to reflect deeply on your work, explore the impact of your professional learning, and set meaningful goals for the future. As you prepare, this structured reflection will help you approach the conversation with clarity, candour, and focus. Below is a guide to help you through the process.

If you have concerns about the professional growth process or conversation, you should discuss this with the senior leader who manages your department or area of our Trust.

*If you are a Deputy Headteacher, Headteacher or Trust Leader, please reflect alongside your 360 review and self audit.*

## For Teaching Staff

Use two or more of the prompts in each section to support your reflection

| Firstly... Reflect positively on your professional contribution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Secondly... Reflect on your context and challenges                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Then... Consider your contribution to strategic priorities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What aspects of your practice are currently having the greatest impact on pupils?</li> <li>• What are you most proud of achieving over the last year?</li> <li>• In what ways are you consistently meeting or exceeding the expectations of your role?</li> <li>• How have you contributed to the success of your department, team, year group, or wider school?</li> <li>• What professional knowledge, skills, or expertise have you developed most significantly?</li> <li>• How have you supported colleagues or contributed to the professional learning of others?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What are the most significant opportunities and challenges within your current context?</li> <li>• Which groups of pupils require your greatest attention and why?</li> <li>• What barriers are preventing pupils from achieving their full potential?</li> <li>• What aspects of your practice are you currently seeking to strengthen or refine?</li> <li>• What changes within the curriculum, assessment, behaviour, attendance, or inclusion landscape are influencing your work?</li> <li>• What support, resources, or professional learning would help you address these challenges?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• How does your role contribute to your school's improvement priorities?</li> <li>• How does your work support our Trust's commitment to improving outcomes and opportunities for all children?</li> <li>• In what ways are you helping to promote inclusion, belonging, and equity?</li> <li>• How are you contributing to continuous improvement within your department or school?</li> <li>• Which strategic priority feels most closely aligned to your day-to-day work and why?</li> <li>• Where could your contribution have greater strategic impact over the coming year?</li> </ul> |

## For TLR Holders

Use two or more of the prompts in each section to support your reflection

| <b>Firstly... Reflect positively on your professional contribution</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Secondly... Reflect on your context and challenges</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Then... Consider your contribution to strategic priorities</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What has been the most significant improvement in your area of responsibility this year?</li> <li>• How have you improved the quality of provision, outcomes, or experiences for pupils?</li> <li>• How have you supported, developed, or influenced colleagues?</li> <li>• What evidence demonstrates the impact of your leadership?</li> <li>• Which leadership strengths have been most evident this year?</li> <li>• How have you built capacity within your team rather than carrying responsibility alone?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What challenges currently exist within your area of leadership?</li> <li>• What trends, patterns, or data concern you most?</li> <li>• What barriers are preventing your team from achieving its ambitions?</li> <li>• Where are the biggest opportunities for improvement?</li> <li>• How effectively are systems and processes supporting improvement?</li> <li>• What leadership skills or knowledge will help you address these challenges?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• How does your leadership support the achievement of school priorities?</li> <li>• How have you translated strategic goals into practical actions within your team?</li> <li>• What contribution has your area made to improving standards, inclusion, attendance, behaviour, wellbeing, or professional development?</li> <li>• Which Trust priority is most closely aligned with your leadership responsibility?</li> <li>• How effectively are you balancing immediate operational demands with longer-term improvement?</li> <li>• What strategic contribution could you make that would have the greatest impact over the next 12 months?</li> </ul> |

## Senior Leaders (Assistant Headteachers)

Use two or more of the prompts in each section to support your reflection. Use your Talent Innovation profile to inform your reflection.

| <b>Firstly... Reflect positively on your professional contribution</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>Secondly... Reflect on your context and challenges</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Then... Consider your contribution to strategic priorities</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What are the most significant successes achieved under your leadership this year?</li> <li>• Which aspects of your leadership have had the greatest impact on pupils, colleagues, and the community?</li> <li>• How have you developed a culture of high expectations, trust, and belonging?</li> <li>• What evidence demonstrates the impact of your leadership on school improvement?</li> <li>• How have you developed other leaders and built organisational capacity?</li> <li>• Which areas of our Trust Blueprint, Headteachers' Standards, or your role have been particular strengths?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What are the most significant contextual challenges facing your school?</li> <li>• How are demographic, financial, staffing, attendance, inclusion, safeguarding, or community factors influencing improvement?</li> <li>• Which challenges require the greatest leadership attention in the coming year?</li> <li>• What risks or barriers may limit progress?</li> <li>• What leadership approaches have been successful in addressing complexity?</li> <li>• What organisational learning has emerged from the challenges faced this year?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• How effectively is your school contributing to our Trust's strategic vision?</li> <li>• Which school improvement priorities have progressed most strongly and why?</li> <li>• Where is the greatest opportunity for accelerated improvement?</li> <li>• How are you ensuring that strategic decisions lead to sustainable improvement?</li> <li>• How are you developing future leaders and organisational capacity?</li> <li>• What legacy do you want your leadership to create over the next three to five years?</li> </ul> |

# Deputy Headteachers/ Trust Directors

Use two or more of the prompts in each section to support your reflection.  
Use your 360 review and self profile to inform your reflection.

| Firstly... Reflect positively on your professional contribution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Secondly... Reflect on your context and challenges                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Then... Consider your contribution to strategic priorities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What has been the most significant impact of your work across our Trust?</li> <li>• How have you influenced strategy, culture, system leadership, or organisational improvement?</li> <li>• What evidence demonstrates improved outcomes, experiences, or efficiencies as a result of your leadership?</li> <li>• How have you strengthened collaboration across schools and teams?</li> <li>• What expertise have you brought that has enhanced Trust-wide effectiveness?</li> <li>• How have you enabled others to succeed?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What system-wide challenges are currently affecting your area of responsibility?</li> <li>• What barriers are slowing progress or limiting impact across schools?</li> <li>• Where are there inconsistencies that require further attention?</li> <li>• What emerging risks or opportunities should shape future priorities?</li> <li>• How effectively are current structures, systems, and resources supporting improvement?</li> <li>• What knowledge, partnerships, or innovation will be needed moving forward?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• How has your work advanced our Trust's strategic objectives?</li> <li>• Which strategic priorities have benefited most from your leadership?</li> <li>• How have your decisions improved outcomes or experiences across multiple schools?</li> <li>• What impact have you had on workforce development, inclusion, school improvement, or organisational effectiveness?</li> <li>• Where can your leadership create greater alignment across our Trust?</li> <li>• What strategic initiatives should be prioritised next to maximise Trust-wide impact?</li> </ul> |

# Headteachers

Use two or more of the prompts in each section to support your reflection. Use your 360 and self profile to inform your reflection.

| Firstly... Reflect positively on your professional contribution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Secondly... Reflect on your context and challenges                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Then... Consider your contribution to strategic priorities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What achievements are you most proud of this year and what contribution did your leadership make to those successes?</li> <li>• How have you improved outcomes, opportunities and experiences for pupils?</li> <li>• In what ways have you developed colleagues and built leadership capacity within your school?</li> <li>• How have you promoted a culture of belonging, inclusion, professional growth and wellbeing?</li> <li>• What evidence best demonstrates the impact of your leadership?</li> <li>• What themes emerge most consistently from your 360-degree feedback?</li> <li>• What leadership strengths do others most frequently recognise in you?</li> <li>• Which aspects of your leadership are having the greatest positive impact on staff, pupils and the wider community?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What are the defining characteristics of your school community currently?</li> <li>• What opportunities exist within your context that can be further developed? What are the most significant barriers affecting pupil outcomes and experiences?</li> <li>• What have been the most significant leadership challenges over the last year? Which challenges remain unresolved and require further attention?</li> <li>• What risks could slow or hinder school improvement?</li> <li>• How have you adapted your leadership in response to changing circumstances?</li> <li>• What organisational systems or processes would benefit from further refinement?</li> <li>• What leadership knowledge, skills or support would help you address future challenges more effectively?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What strategic priorities should command your greatest attention over the next twelve months?</li> <li>• What legacy do you want to leave through your leadership?</li> <li>• Which aspects of your leadership would you like to strengthen further? Where can your school contribute more significantly to Trust-wide improvement?</li> <li>• What will success look like for your school a year from now, and what leadership actions will be most important in achieving it?</li> <li>• In what ways have you embodied and promoted the values and behaviours outlined in our Trust Blueprint?</li> <li>• How are you contributing to collaboration and collective improvement beyond your own school?</li> <li>• What examples demonstrate your contribution to Trust-wide improvement?</li> </ul> |

## Executive Leaders/ CEO

Use two or more of the prompts in each section to support your reflection. Use your 360 review and self profile to inform your reflection.

| <b>Firstly... Reflect positively on your professional contribution</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>Secondly... Reflect on your context and challenges</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Then... Consider your contribution to strategic priorities</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What are the most significant achievements of our Trust over the last year and what has been your contribution to them?</li> <li>• How have you advanced our Trust's mission, vision, and values?</li> <li>• Which strategic decisions have had the most significant positive impact on our pupils, staff, schools, and communities?</li> <li>• How have you strengthened organisational culture and leadership capacity?</li> <li>• What evidence demonstrates the effectiveness of your executive leadership?</li> <li>• How have you ensured that our Trust remains focused on both performance and purpose?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What are the most significant external and internal challenges facing our Trust?</li> <li>• How is the wider educational landscape influencing strategic decision-making?</li> <li>• Which risks require the greatest executive oversight?</li> <li>• What tensions are emerging between ambition, sustainability, capacity, and resource?</li> <li>• Where must our Trust adapt, innovate, or change to continue improving?</li> <li>• What leadership behaviours will be most important in navigating future complexity?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• How effectively is our Trust delivering against its strategic priorities?</li> <li>• Which areas have seen the strongest improvement and which require renewed focus?</li> <li>• How are you ensuring alignment between purpose, people, and place?</li> <li>• What strategic decisions now will have the greatest long-term impact?</li> <li>• How are you building the next generation of leaders across our Trust?</li> <li>• What should success look like for our Trust three to five years from now, and what must happen next to achieve it?</li> </ul> |